

Meet Cute - Quick Start

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Live app: `meetcutehq.com`

Meet Cute is an invite-only, matchmaker-run dating service. There is no swiping: a human operator (matchmaker) curates one introduction at a time, both people opt in, and a concierge bot books the first date. Everyone signs in the same way: a passwordless magic link sent to their email. What you can see is determined by one flag on your account: members get the app, operators get the studio.

Two surfaces

Surface	URL	Who	What they do
Member app	<code>/app</code>	Applicants & active members	Build a profile, review one curated suggestion at a time, opt in/pass, get a date booked, vouch for friends, manage safety + privacy.
Matchmaker studio	<code>/studio</code>	Operators only	Vet applicants, search the roster, create suggestions, run the pipeline, moderate photos/reports, manage the team, use the AI co-pilot.

Members can never see or reach the studio. Every `/studio/*` route redirects non-operators to `/app`, and every operator action is enforced server-side.

Member workflow

1. **Apply** at `/apply` → enter email → click the sign-in link.
2. **Complete the application**: name, date of birth (18+ gate), city, what you're looking for, and consent to Terms + Privacy.
3. An operator **vets and approves** you (status goes `applicant → active`).
4. **Build your profile** at `/app/profile`: headline, bio, what you're looking for, deal-breakers, and photos (reviewed before others see them).
5. **For You** (`/app`) shows **one** introduction at a time with the matchmaker's note on why. Choose **Yes, introduce us** or **Not this time**.

6. If **both** say yes, it becomes mutual and the **concierge** takes over in `/app/matches`: it proposes a venue + specific time slots; when your picks overlap it confirms and sends a calendar invite.
7. **Safety + privacy** in `/app/settings`: block or report anyone, export your data, or permanently delete your account and all its data.

Operator workflow

1. Sign in → you land in `/studio`.
 2. **Roster** (`/studio`): search/filter members; vet applicants (approve → active, or decline).
 3. **Person view** (`/studio/person/[id]`): full history, notes, mutual-friend graph; one-click create a suggestion with a rationale.
 4. **Pipeline** (`/studio/pipeline`): every match from suggested → together; see who's waiting on whom.
 5. **Events** (`/studio/events`): create a dinner/gathering (theme, venue, city, date, capacity), then **one-click add invitees** from the roster; each checked member is added and **emailed automatically**. Manage RSVPs (invited/confirmed/attended/no-show) on the event page.
 6. **Moderation** (`/studio/moderation`): approve/reject pending photos; resolve safety reports.
 7. **Co-pilot** (`/studio/copilot`): your command line for the platform. As well as answering questions over the roster + notes, **typed commands run for real**:
 - `Match Maya and Alex`
 - `Invite Maya and Alex to the next NYC dinner` (adds + emails them)
 - `Create a NYC dinner at Via Carota on 2026-07-12 7pm`
 - `Book the date for Maya`
 - `Approve Maya's photos` · `Close the match for Maya` · `What needs my attention?`
 8. **Team** (`/studio/team`): add another operator by email (sends them a sign-in link) or revoke access. You can't remove yourself or the last operator.
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Logins & testing

Everyone signs in with a magic link. For accounts whose inbox you don't control (e.g. test accounts), mint a **direct one-click link** instead (single-use, expires in 15 minutes):

```
npm run login-link -- jesswolflord@gmail.com # operator → /studio
npm run login-link -- maya@meetcute.test     # member  → /app
npm run login-link -- alex@meetcute.test     # member  → /app
```

SEED / RESET THE TEST SCENARIO

```
npm run test:fixture
```

Creates two members (**Maya Rosen** and **Alex Chen**) and one curated suggestion between them, reset to a clean “both undecided” state. Walk it:

1. Open Maya’s link → on **For You** you’ll see Alex suggested with the matchmaker’s note → click **Yes, introduce us**.
2. Open Alex’s link → he sees Maya → **Yes, introduce us**. It’s now mutual.
3. Either member’s **Matches** tab shows the concierge proposing a venue and time slots. Pick slots on both sides to see it confirm + send the invite.
4. Open Jessica’s (operator) link → **Studio** → **Pipeline** shows the match advancing; **Roster**, **Moderation**, and **Team** are all here.

MANAGE OPERATORS

```
npm run ops -- list
npm run ops -- add you@email.com "Your Name" NYC # or use /studio/team
npm run ops -- remove someone@email.com
```

Production notes

- **Photo uploads at scale:** set `BLOB_READ_WRITE_TOKEN` (Vercel Blob) as a Fly secret. Without it, uploads fall back to local disk on a single machine.
- **Schema changes:** apply with `npm run db:deploy` (never via the build).